

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Craftgali

A discovery-first marketplace for Indian artists and handmade creators

Version

1.0 — Draft for build planning

Scope

Buyer, seller and admin product; page inventory; application flows; trust & safety; listing-quality automation; monetization; technical architecture

Date

September 2026

Product: Craftgali — a discovery-first marketplace for Indian artists and handmade creators **Scope of this document:** whole product (buyer + seller + admin), page inventory, application flows, trust & safety, listing quality automation, monetization, and technical architecture **Status:** Draft for build planning **Date:** September 2026

0. Read this first — three structural decisions to lock before building

These three things change the schema, the legal footing, and the roadmap. Everything downstream depends on them.

0.1 You are building a *classifieds platform*, not a marketplace

You have said the platform will not handle payments, shipping, or fulfilment — buyers and sellers meet offline or courier it themselves. That is a legitimate and capital-light model (OLX, Quikr, Facebook Marketplace), but it means:

- **Do not call your fee a "commission."** The attached seller PRD uses "Advanced Upfront Commission Model." A commission implies you took a cut of a transaction you facilitated, which invites GST-on-marketplace-supply questions, TCS under Section 194-O, and consumer-protection liability for a sale you had no visibility into. Rename it to a **High-Value Listing Fee** priced as a percentage of the asking price. Same money, correct legal shape. Charge GST on your fee (a service you actually rendered) and nothing else.
- **Your terms must state clearly** that Craftgali is an intermediary providing listing and discovery services, that no contract of sale is formed on the platform, and that Craftgali is not party to the transaction. This is what gives you safe-harbour protection under Section 79 of the IT Act, and it is conditional on you actually running a grievance-redressal process (name a Grievance Officer on the site — this is mandatory under the IT Rules 2021).
- **You cannot hold money in transit** without being a licensed Payment Aggregator or routing through one. If you ever add escrow — and Section 4 argues you eventually should for auctions — do it through Razorpay Route / Cashfree Easy Split, never through your own nodal-style account.

0.2 Auctions without escrow will break

This is the single biggest risk in the concept as described. In a no-escrow auction, the winning bidder can simply not show up. There is no penalty, no money at stake, and the seller has held a ₹40,000 painting off the market for seven days for nothing. One bad experience of this per seller is enough to churn them permanently, and bad actors will farm it for fun.

Three options, in order of preference:

Option	Mechanism	Trade-off
A. Bid deposit (recommended)	Bidder authorises a refundable hold (₹250, or 2% of reserve capped at ₹2,000) before their first bid on an auction. Released automatically on loss or on completed deal; forfeited on no-show, split 50/50 seller/platform.	Requires a PA integration and a hold/capture flow. Adds friction — but friction is the point; it filters out exactly the people you don't want bidding.
B. Verified-bidder gate	Only KYC-verified accounts with ≥ 1 completed transaction can bid above ₹10,000. No money at risk, reputation is.	Zero payment complexity. Weak deterrent for a first-time abuser with a burner. Fine for a v1 pilot.
C. Best-offer instead of auctions	Replace open auctions with sealed "make an offer" — buyer submits a price, seller accepts/counters/declines, then the normal chat flow starts.	Loses the drama and urgency that makes auctions good for engagement. But it is 10% of the build cost and has none of the no-show problem.

Recommendation: ship **C** in the MVP, ship **A** in v1.1 for listings above ₹7,000 only. Do not build open auctions for a ₹800 macramé plant hanger — the format only earns its complexity on scarce, high-value, one-of-one work.

0.3 Your pricing has three contradictions in it

Between the attached PRD and the brief, these numbers conflict:

- Attached PRD: extra listing pack = **₹299 / 3 months for up to 30 items** (standard sellers).
- Attached PRD: Pro Unlimited = **₹299 / month, unlimited listings**. This makes the ₹299 pack irrational — nobody buys 30 slots for 3 months when unlimited costs the same for 1 month and is 4x better value at 3 months.
- Brief: "₹150 for 30 products, ₹300 for 70."

A single coherent ladder is proposed in Section 4. Pick one and put it in a config table, not in code.

1. Product overview

1.1 One-line positioning

Craftgali is where India discovers its neighbourhood artists — a place for painters, potters, sculptors, and home creators to run a beautiful storefront, be found by people who love their kind of work, and sell directly to them, with no commission on the sale.

1.2 The three things that make it work

1. **Discovery, not search.** Etsy is a search engine. Instagram is a feed with no commerce structure. Craftgali is a *feed with commerce structure* — you scroll art the way you scroll Instagram, but every piece has a price, a size, a maker, and a buy path.
2. **Zero commission on the sale.** The seller keeps 100% of what the buyer pays. This is the headline that gets artists to move, and it is only credible *because* you don't touch the transaction. Monetise the shelf space, not the sale.

3. **The maker is the product.** Behind-the-scenes stories, hours invested, material breakdowns, the artist's bio. A ₹15,000 painting sells on the story of the person who made it; a ₹15,000 sofa does not. This is the moat against Amazon Karigar and Meesho.

1.3 Non-goals (explicitly out of scope)

- Payments, escrow, or wallets for the sale itself (fees only)
- Logistics, shipping labels, packaging, or delivery tracking
- Returns, refunds, or buyer-protection guarantees
- Mass-produced or resold goods, print-on-demand, or dropshipping
- Inventory/warehouse management, or SKU variants beyond simple size/colour options
- International shipping ops (the *portfolio* is global; the *transaction* is local, in v1)

1.4 Design principles

- **Automate the gatekeeping, humanise the exceptions.** Every quality and trust decision has a machine-scored default; humans only see the 2% that the machine is unsure about.
 - **Visibility is the enforcement lever, not deletion.** Bad photos don't get rejected, they get ranked to the bottom with a clear reason and a fix. Deletion generates support tickets; demotion generates behaviour change.
 - **Friction scales with rupees.** A ₹500 listing needs a phone number. A ₹50,000 listing needs KYC, a video, and a verified UPI handle. Never make the hobbyist do the high-value flow.
 - **Every screen a seller sees should make them feel like an artist, not a vendor.** No "SKU," no "inventory," no "GMV." The vocabulary is *pieces*, *collections*, *studio*, *showcase*.
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2. Personas

Persona	Who	Primary need	What kills them
Anaya — Independent Artist	28, Pune, professional painter, 4k Instagram followers, sells 2-4 pieces/month via DMs	A real storefront + a link she can put in her bio; escape from DM-based price negotiation and screenshots	Any platform that takes 20% of a ₹30,000 sale
Vikram — Hobbyist	41, Bengaluru, weekend potter with 30 pieces stacked in a spare room	Low-stakes way to clear work and get validation; wouldn't pay a monthly fee	Onboarding that asks for GST number or bank details on screen one
Sunita — Home Creator	35, Patna, macramé and resin decor, wants ₹8-15k/month of household income	Local buyers, cash on hand, no shipping headache, safety when meeting strangers	Having to display her home address; a buyer asking for advance payment
Rhea — Buyer/Collector	32, Delhi, decorating a new flat, budget ₹5-25k	Finding original work that isn't mass-produced; confidence the artist is real	No way to tell a real artist from a reseller of Amazon prints
Ops/Moderator	Internal, 1 person at launch	Clear a review queue in <30 min/day	A queue that shows them every listing instead of only ambiguous ones

3. Feature scope by phase

MVP (weeks 0-12) — "a beautiful place to list and be found"

Auth & phone OTP · seller onboarding · storefront/portfolio at craftgali.com/@handle · listing creation with automated image QC · Discover feed + two streams (Art & Paintings, Handmade Decor) · search & filters · listing detail page · in-app chat · make-an-offer · mark-as-sold · reviews · report/block · listing slot metering + paid packs · high-value listing fee · admin moderation console · trust score v1.

V1.1 (weeks 12-20) — "trust and money"

KYC via DigiLocker/Aadhaar · verified-artist badges · bid-deposit auctions for ₹7,000+ · Safe Exchange Zones directory · saved searches + alerts · collections · seller analytics · founding-seller tier machinery · referral loop.

V1.2 (weeks 20-32) — "community and depth"

Neighbourhood Creator Hub · artist collaborations / co-authored listings · joint showdrops · commissions/custom-request flow · "The Making Of" video · Expo mobile app · vernacular UI (Hindi first, then Bengali/Tamil/Marathi).

Deliberately deferred

Co-creation listings and the community hub are in the attached PRD as core features. They are *retention* features, and you cannot retain users you don't have. Both require a critical mass of sellers in one pin

code to be non-empty. Ship them when a single city has 300+ active sellers, not before.

4. Monetization

4.1 Model summary

Three revenue lines, none of which touch the sale:

1. **Listing slots** — how many pieces you can have live at once
2. **High-value listing fee** — a one-time percentage fee on expensive pieces, buying a longer listing validity
3. **Promotion** — featured placement, later (v1.2+)

4.2 Listing slot ladder (proposed — resolves the conflict in §0.3)

Plan	Price	Active listing slots	Validity	Notes
Free (forever)	₹0	10	Perpetual	Every seller starts here. No card required, ever.
Pack S	₹149	+30 slots	90 days	The impulse purchase. Prices below the ₹200 "don't-think-about-it" line.
Pack M	₹299	+70 slots	90 days	Best rupee-per-slot value in the pack tier.
Pro Studio	₹599/month or ₹4,999/year	Unlimited	Recurring	Adds: analytics, custom storefront theme, 3 featured slots/month, priority support, "Pro" badge. Annual = 7 months free.
Flexi (pay-per-piece)	₹30/piece	1 extra slot	90 days	For the seller with exactly 12 pieces. Keeps them from bouncing at the paywall.

Rules:

- Slots are **concurrent active listings**, not lifetime uploads. Marking a piece sold frees the slot immediately. Say this in the UI in exactly those words — it is the #1 source of confusion in slot-metered products.
- Packs stack additively and each expires independently. On expiry, listings above the new cap are **auto-archived oldest-first** (never deleted), with a 7-day warning email and an in-app banner offering renewal.
- Pro Studio at ₹599 must be strictly better than Pack M at ₹299/quarter. It is: unlimited + features vs 70 slots.

4.3 High-value listing fee

Replaces the "upfront commission" in the attached PRD. One-time, charged at publish, non-refundable, buys extended listing validity.

Asking price	Fee	Listing validity	Example fee
₹0 – ₹6,999	0%	90 days (renewable free)	₹0
₹7,000 – ₹14,999	1.9%	4 months	₹190 on ₹10,000
₹15,000 – ₹19,999	2.9%	6 months	₹464 on ₹16,000
₹20,000+	5.0%	8 months	₹2,500 on ₹50,000

Fix the band boundaries. The attached PRD writes "₹7,000 – ₹15,000" and "₹15,000 – ₹20,000" — overlapping at the endpoints. Use half-open intervals `[7000, 15000)` in code and inclusive-exclusive language in the UI.

Watch the 5% band. On a ₹50,000 sculpture that's ₹2,500 upfront, from a seller who has earned ₹0 on your platform and has no guarantee of a sale. This is the highest-friction moment in your entire product. Two mitigations:

- **Show the arithmetic against the alternative.** "On Etsy this piece would cost you ₹3,250 in fees *after* it sells, plus 6.5% payment processing. Here you pay ₹2,500 once and keep every rupee of the sale."
- **Cap it.** ₹5,000 maximum fee on any single listing. Above ₹1,00,000 the percentage stops being defensible.
- **Offer a sale-contingent alternative for verified sellers:** ₹0 upfront, ₹X on marking sold, enforced by pausing the account on non-payment. Only for sellers with ≥ 3 completed transactions — it converts a payment problem into a reputation problem, which you can actually enforce.

4.4 Founding Seller tiers (first 15,000)

Keep as specified in the attached PRD, with two changes:

- **Tier assignment is by *approved seller number*, not *signup number*.** Otherwise you burn Tier 1 on 5,000 accounts that never list anything. The counter increments when a seller publishes their first listing that passes QC.
- **Make the counter public and live** on the landing page: "3,847 of 5,000 Tier-1 spots left." Scarcity is the whole mechanic; hiding it wastes it.

Tier	Range	Free slots	Duration	Badge	Exposure
1	1-5,000	25	6 months	Diamond	Homepage feature + social spotlight
2	5,001-10,000	20	3 months	Gold	Category page feature
3	10,001-15,000	15	1 month	Silver	Standard listing priority

All three tiers get Pack S at ₹149 permanently (vs ₹299 for later sellers) — a lasting, cheap-to-give perk that makes the badge mean something after the free period ends.

4.5 Pricing guardrails

- Every price lives in a `plans` / `fee_bands` table with effective-from dates. Never hardcode. You will change these numbers four times in year one.
- Grandfather existing subscribers on price increases. Announce 30 days ahead.
- Show the fee **before** the seller finishes writing the listing, not at the payment step. Surprise fees at checkout are the top cause of abandoned listings.

5. Information architecture & page inventory

URL scheme is deliberate: artist handles sit at the root (`/@anaya`) so the portfolio link is short and shareable — that link is your primary organic acquisition channel.

5.1 Public / buyer surface

#	Page	Route	Purpose & key elements
P1	Landing (logged-out)	/	Hero, live founding-seller counter, "start selling free" + "explore art" CTAs, featured artists, trust explainer. SSG.
P2	Discover feed	/discover	Infinite masonry grid, personalised. Filter rail: stream, price, medium, size, city/radius, availability, artist verification level. The default landing for logged-in users.
P3	Stream page	/art , /decor	Curated vertical: Art & Paintings, Handmade Decor. Editorial hero + sub-category chips (oil, acrylic, watercolour, ceramic, macramé, resin, woodwork...). ISR.
P4	Category / tag page	/art/watercolour , /decor/macrame	SEO landing pages. One per medium × optionally city. This is where your Google traffic comes from — treat as a first-class surface, not an afterthought.
P5	Search results	/search?q=	Query + all filters + sort (relevance, newest, price, nearby, ending soon).
P6	Listing detail	/@handle/p/{slug}-{id}	Image gallery (zoom, swipe), price, dimensions, medium, "The Making Of" story block, hours invested, materials, artist mini-card, availability, delivery preference (meetup / seller-couriers / buyer-arranges), Message artist / Make an offer / Place bid , save, share, report. Similar pieces. Full schema.org Product markup.
P7	Auction detail	/@handle/a/{id}	As above plus live bid ladder, countdown with anti-snipe indicator, reserve-met state, bid history, deposit explainer.
P8	Artist storefront	/@handle	The portfolio. Cover image, avatar, bio, creative statement, location (city only), badges, stats (pieces, sold, joined, response time), collections, active pieces grid, sold archive, reviews, Communication Wall, follow, share. Must be SSR + OG image generated per artist.
P9	Artist collections	/@handle/c/{slug}	Themed grouping ("Monsoon Series", "Small Works Under ₹3,000").
P10	Artist reviews	/@handle/reviews	Paginated, with the transaction context each review came from.
P11	Communication Wall	/@handle/wall	Public Q&A thread on the artist's profile. Moderated by the artist + auto-filter.
P12	Chat inbox	/messages	Conversation list, unread, filters (buying / selling / offers).
P13	Chat thread	/messages/{id}	Message stream, pinned listing card, offer/counter-offer chips, meetup proposal card, safety banner, report, block.
P14	Deal page	/deals/{id}	The lightweight record of an agreed transaction: what, price, mode, status timeline, "mark complete", review CTA. Not an order — no payment state.
P15	Saved / wishlist	/saved	Saved pieces, saved searches, followed artists.
P16	Buyer profile	/me	Public-lite profile: name, city, joined, reviews received as buyer.

#	Page	Route	Purpose & key elements
P17	Notifications	<code>/notifications</code>	Grouped, actionable.
P18	Neighbourhood Hub	<code>/hub</code> (v1.2)	Local feed: posts, events, showdrops, within radius.
P19	Safe Exchange Zones	<code>/safe-zones</code>	Map of vetted public meetup points per city (police-station forecourts, mall atriums, partner cafés).
P20	Trust & Safety centre	<code>/trust</code>	How verification works, how to spot a scam, what Craftgali does and does not guarantee.
P21	Static/legal	<code>/about</code> , <code>/terms</code> , <code>/privacy</code> , <code>/fees</code> , <code>/guidelines</code> , <code>/grievance</code>	Grievance Officer name + contact is legally required.
P22	Report flow	modal, any surface	Reason picker → evidence → confirmation.
P23	Auth	<code>/login</code> , <code>/verify</code>	Phone OTP primary; Google as secondary.

5.2 Seller surface

#	Page	Route	Purpose
S1	Become a seller	<code>/sell</code>	Value prop, fee calculator (interactive — let them type a price and see the fee), founding-tier counter.
S2	Onboarding wizard	<code>/sell/start</code>	5 steps, ≤4 minutes: persona → handle + display name → what you make (streams/mediums) → city + radius → first piece. KYC deferred, not here.
S3	Studio dashboard	<code>/studio</code>	Slot meter ("7 of 10 pieces live"), views this week, unanswered messages (with response-time impact), pending offers, expiring listings, next best action card.
S4	Create listing	<code>/studio/new</code>	Multi-step: photos → auto-QC feedback → title/story → price/fee preview → dimensions/materials/hours → availability & handover → publish. Autosaves as draft at every step.
S5	Listing manager	<code>/studio/pieces</code>	Table/grid, bulk actions, status (draft, in review, live, limited-visibility, sold, archived, expired), quality score per piece with fix hints.
S6	Edit listing	<code>/studio/pieces/{id}</code>	Same form, versioned. Re-runs QC on image change. Price changes that cross a fee band trigger a fee delta.
S7	Auction manager	<code>/studio/auctions</code>	Create/monitor/close, bidder list, no-show reporting.
S8	Offers	<code>/studio/offers</code>	Incoming offers, accept/counter/decline, expiry timers.
S9	Storefront editor	<code>/studio/storefront</code>	Cover, avatar, bio, creative statement, theme (Pro), collection curation, pinned pieces, live preview.
S10	Plan & slots	<code>/studio/plan</code>	Current plan, slot ledger, purchase packs, invoices/GST, cancel.
S11	Verification centre	<code>/studio/verify</code>	Progressive: phone → email → UPI name match → ID (DigiLocker) → studio video. Each unlocks something specific and named.
S12	Analytics	<code>/studio/insights</code>	Views, saves, message rate, conversion, traffic source, search terms that found you, price-band benchmarking vs peers. (Pro tier gets depth.)
S13	Reviews received	<code>/studio/reviews</code>	With right of reply.
S14	Collaborations	<code>/studio/collabs</code> (v1.2)	Invite artist, accept, split credit.
S15	Appeals	<code>/studio/appeals</code>	Contest a QC rejection or enforcement action. One free re-review per listing.
S16	Settings	<code>/studio/settings</code>	Notifications, radius, availability/vacation mode, blocked users, delete account.

5.3 Admin / ops console (`/admin`)

Built for one person, half an hour a day.

#	Page	Purpose
A1	Ops home	Queue depths, SLA breaches, today's signups/listings/reports, fraud-signal spikes
A2	Moderation queue	Only ambiguous items. Card view: images, auto-scores, model rationale, seller history. Keyboard-driven (A = approve, R = reject + reason, E = escalate). Target: 8 seconds per item.
A3	Image QC review	Sub-queue for aesthetic borderline cases (score 38-52)
A4	KYC review	Only where automated ID match failed
A5	Reports & disputes	User-submitted, threaded, with canned resolutions
A6	User 360	Every signal for one account: devices, IPs, listings, messages flagged, trust score history, linked accounts
A7	Listing 360	Full history, QC scores, edits, duplicate matches
A8	Fraud rules console	Rule list, thresholds, dry-run mode, hit rates. Rules as data, not deploys.
A9	Plans & fees config	Prices, bands, tier counters
A10	Featured slots scheduler	Homepage/category placement calendar
A11	Content/CMS	Editorial hero copy, stream curation, safe-zone directory
A12	Metrics	Funnels, cohorts, revenue
A13	Audit log	Immutable record of every admin action. Non-negotiable — you will need it in a dispute.

6. Core flows

6.1 Seller onboarding

```

/sell → "Start free" → phone + OTP → display name + handle (live availability check)
  → "What do you make?" (multi-select mediums, maps to streams)
  → City + willing-to-travel radius
  → [Founding tier assigned & shown: "You're Founding Seller #3,214 – Diamond tier"]
  → "Add your first piece" → S4 listing flow

```

Rules:

- **No KYC, no bank details, no GST, no email verification** in this flow. Every field you add here costs ~8% of completions.
- Handle is permanent-ish (one change allowed, ever, with a redirect kept forever).
- Seller and buyer are the same account type. A buyer becomes a seller by publishing. No separate signup.
- Target: **under 4 minutes to first published piece**. Instrument every step; anything with >20% drop-off gets cut or deferred.

6.2 Listing creation & quality gate

1. Upload 3–10 photos (drag/drop, or in-app guided camera on mobile)
2. Client-side pre-check: resolution $\geq 1200\text{px}$, $\leq 10\text{MB}$, JPEG/PNG/HEIC/WebP
→ instant reject with plain-English reason, no server round trip
3. Async QC pipeline runs (§8) while the seller keeps typing – never block the form
4. Title, story ("The Making Of"), materials, hours invested
5. Price → live fee preview → "You'll receive ₹X of every ₹X. Listing fee ₹Y, one time."
6. Dimensions, weight, framed/unframed, year made, one-of-one vs made-to-order
7. Availability: meetup (radius) / seller couriers / buyer arranges pickup
8. QC verdict returns → one of:
 - PASS (≥ 70) → publish immediately, eligible for Discover + featured
 - SOFT (40–69) → publish, but limited visibility; show the 2 specific fixes
 - FAIL (< 40) → hold, show exactly what's wrong with an annotated thumbnail
 - FLAG → human queue (duplicate match, suspected stock photo, policy risk)
9. Slot check: if no free slot → paywall with pack options + Flexi
10. Payment (if any) → publish → share sheet ("post to Instagram") → done

The share sheet at step 10 matters more than it looks. Every seller who shares their listing brings you buyers you didn't pay for. Auto-generate a square, watermarked, Instagram-ready image with the price and handle.

6.3 Buyer discovery → deal → completion

- Discover/search → Listing detail → [Message artist] or [Make an offer]
- Chat opens with the listing pinned as the first card
 - Safety banner: "Never pay in advance. Meet in a public place. Craftgali does not process payments and cannot recover money sent outside the app."
 - Negotiation happens in chat; offer/counter as structured chips (not free text – structured offers give you price data and let you detect deal formation)
 - Either party taps [Agree deal] → creates a Deal record (P14) with price + mode
 - Handover happens offline
 - T+0: both prompted to confirm completion. T+24h and T+72h reminders.
 - Seller marks Sold → listing → Out of Stock → removed from feeds, slot freed, piece moves to the artist's "Sold archive" (social proof, keep it visible)
 - Both prompted to review (double-blind: neither sees the other's until both submit or 7 days pass – this is what stops retaliatory reviews)

The critical design problem: you cannot verify a deal happened, and you have no financial hook. So make *marking sold* rewarding rather than obligatory:

- It frees a slot instantly (immediate, tangible value)
- It unlocks the review, which builds the seller's public reputation
- Sold pieces stay visible on the storefront with a "Sold" ribbon — social proof that the artist actually sells
- Completed transactions are the input to the trust score, which drives ranking

6.4 Auction lifecycle (v1.1, ₹7,000+ only)

Seller: create auction → reserve price, start price, duration (3/5/7 days), min increment
→ high-value listing fee charged at publish (same bands)

Bidder: first bid on that auction → deposit hold authorised (₹250 or 2% capped ₹2,000)
→ bid placed (server-authoritative, row-locked, monotonic)
→ outbid → push notification within 5s, deposit released if they walk away

Anti-snipe: any bid in the final 120s extends end time by 120s (log every extension)

Close job fires at end_at:

- reserve met → winner declared, deposits released for all losers, chat auto-opens between winner and seller with a 48h handover window
- reserve not met → seller offered "sell to highest bidder at ₹X?" (one-tap)
- winner no-show reported by seller → 24h response window for the bidder → deposit forfeited (50% to seller as compensation, 50% platform), strike on account, 3 strikes = permanent bidding ban

Non-negotiable technical requirements: bids are ordered by server timestamp under a row lock, every bid is idempotent (client-generated key), and the auction close is a durable scheduled job that is safe to run twice.

6.5 Report & enforcement

Report (listing / user / message) → reason taxonomy → auto-triage:

- High-confidence policy violation (nudity, weapons, counterfeit brand) → auto-hide, notify
- Pattern match against known fraud signals → auto-restrict + human queue
- Everything else → human queue with SLA (24h; 4h for safety/harassment)

Enforcement ladder: warn → limit visibility → suspend listing → suspend account
→ permanent ban + device/phone blocklist

Every action is appealable once. Every action is logged.

7. Trust & anti-scam — the system

Your constraint is "limited human work." The answer is a **layered, cost-ascending funnel**: cheap deterministic checks catch most of it, statistical signals catch more, a model handles ambiguity, and a human sees only what survives all three. Each layer should reduce the volume reaching the next by roughly an order of magnitude.

7.1 Threat model — what actually goes wrong

Threat	How it manifests here	Priority
Advance-fee fraud	Fake seller lists attractive art at a low price, asks for UPI advance "to reserve it", disappears	Critical
Image theft	Scraper lists photos taken from Instagram/Pinterest/Etsy artists, never intends to deliver	Critical
Resale/mass-produced goods	Amazon prints and Sadar Bazaar wholesale decor listed as "handmade" — destroys the core proposition	High
Off-platform diversion	"WhatsApp me on 98..." in the first message, moving before you can log signals	High
AI-generated art passed as original	Midjourney output sold as an original painting	High
Buyer no-show / time-wasting	Especially in auctions (see §0.2)	Medium
Fake reviews / rating rings	Small clusters of accounts reviewing each other	Medium
Physical safety at meetup	Robbery, harassment, stalking via listing location	Critical (severity)
Counterfeit & prohibited goods	Brand knock-offs, wildlife products (ivory, feathers, shell), weapons-adjacent	High

7.2 Layer 1 — Identity friction that scales with money

Progressive verification. Never ask for more than the transaction size justifies.

Level	Requirement	Unlocks	Cost to you
L0	Phone OTP	Browse, message, list up to ₹6,999	₹0.15/SMS
L1	Email + profile completeness (bio, avatar, 3+ pieces)	Discover feed eligibility, "Active" badge	₹0
L2	UPI VPA name match — seller enters their UPI ID, you send ₹1, read back the registered name, match against profile name	List up to ₹19,999, receive offers	~₹1 + gateway fee
L3	DigiLocker / Aadhaar-based eKYC (via Signzy, IDfy, Karza, or Setu)	List above ₹20,000, run auctions, Verified Artist badge	₹15–30/verification
L4	Studio video — 20-second unedited clip, artist visible with 2+ listed pieces and a handwritten slip showing their handle + today's date	Verified Maker badge, homepage eligibility, top-of-feed ranking	1 human review, ~20s

The L4 handwritten-slip trick is borrowed from Reddit's verification culture and is remarkably effective: it is nearly impossible to fake with stolen imagery, takes the honest seller 40 seconds, and takes a moderator 20 seconds to check. Make it the visible signal buyers are taught to look for. **Sell the**

badge, not the burden — "Verified Makers get 4x more messages" converts far better than "verification required."

7.3 Layer 2 — Deterministic and statistical signals (zero human cost)

Run at signup, listing, and message time. Each fires a weighted signal into a trust score.

Account signals

- Phone number reputation (VOIP/virtual number detection — block Textnow-class ranges)
- Disposable email domain blocklist
- Device fingerprint reuse across accounts (>2 accounts per device = flag)
- IP: datacenter/VPN detection, country mismatch with claimed city, velocity (>3 signups per IP per day)
- Time-to-first-listing under 90 seconds with 8+ photos = almost certainly a scraper
- Handle/display-name similarity to an existing verified artist (Levenshtein + soundex) — impersonation

Listing signals

- **Perceptual hash (pHash/dHash) against your own corpus** — catches the same photo relisted across accounts. This is your highest-value single check and it costs microseconds.
- **Reverse image search against the open web** (Google Vision Web Detection, TinEye, or Bing Visual Search API) — catches photos lifted from Instagram/Etsy. Run only on listings above ₹5,000 or from L0/L1 sellers, to control cost.
- **EXIF analysis**: missing EXIF entirely on all photos + identical dimensions across all images = downloaded, not shot. Present EXIF with a phone camera model and a recent timestamp = strong positive signal. (Note: many platforms strip EXIF, so treat absence as weak-negative, presence as strong-positive.)
- **Stock-photo / studio-render detection**: pure white #FFFFFF background covering >85% of the frame with no shadow, on a "handmade" listing, is a catalogue image, not the seller's photo.
- **AI-generation detection**: C2PA/content-credential metadata check, plus a detector model (Hive, Sightengine, or an open SDXL-detector). Don't ban AI art — require it to be *labelled*, and give it its own filter. Buyers will do the enforcement for you.
- **Price anomaly**: price >2.5 standard deviations below the median for that medium × size × city. Underpriced is the oldest bait in the book.
- **Text signals**: contact info in the description (phone regex, @, "whatsapp", Telegram handles, UPI VPA regex `[\w.-]+@[a-z]{3,}`), urgency language, "shipping worldwide DHL" on a ₹900 item.

Message signals (run a lightweight classifier on the first 3 messages of every new conversation)

- Advance-payment request from a seller: "pay 50% now", "send GPay to book", "token amount" — **inject a hard interstitial warning to the buyer, in the chat, in the moment**. This one intervention will prevent more fraud than anything else you build.
- Immediate off-platform push: phone number or WhatsApp mention in the first two messages from a seller with <3 completed deals
- Copy-paste velocity: identical message body sent to >5 conversations in an hour

Review signals

- Reciprocal review pairs, review-graph clustering, reviews from accounts <48h old, review bursts

7.4 Layer 3 — Trust score

A single 0–100 score per account, recomputed on every meaningful event, decomposed and visible in Admin (A6). **It never appears as a number to users** — it drives ranking, limits, and queue routing only.

```
trust = w1·verification_level

+ w2·transaction_history (completed deals, weighted by recency)
+ w3·review_quality (Bayesian-smoothed, so 1 five-star ≠ 50 five-stars)
+ w4·content_quality (mean listing QC score)
+ w5·responsiveness (median reply time, message answer rate)
+ w6·tenure (log-scaled days active)
- p1·reports_upheld
- p2·fraud_signal_hits (decaying)
- p3·no_shows
- p4·qc_failures
```

Band behaviour:

Band	Score	Treatment
New	—	Max 3 live listings for 7 days, capped at ₹9,999 each, no auctions, chat rate-limited to 10 new conversations/day
Building	30–59	Normal limits, no featured placement
Trusted	60–84	Full limits, featured eligible, reduced QC sampling
Established	85+	Auto-approve listings, priority support, early access to features
Restricted	<30	Listings hidden from Discover, cannot initiate chats, all listings human-reviewed

The **new-seller cage** is the most important row in that table. Almost all fraud comes from accounts under 72 hours old. Constraining them costs you almost nothing (a genuine new seller rarely has 10 pieces ready on day one) and removes most of the attack surface.

7.5 Layer 4 — Humans, minimally

- **Queue only ambiguity.** Anything the system is confident about (>0.9 or <0.1) is auto-decided. Target: $<5\%$ of listings ever reach a human.
- **Random audit sample:** 1% of auto-approved listings and 5% of high-value ones go to the queue anyway. This is your only defence against model drift and is how you generate labelled training data.
- **Community reporting with weighted reporters.** Reports from Established accounts and from artists whose work was stolen carry 5x weight and can auto-hide a listing pending review.
- **A dedicated "this is my artwork" flow** for the artist whose photos were stolen — accept a link to the original post plus a matching-account check, act within 12 hours. Word of this spreading through the artist community is worth more marketing than any ad.

7.6 Physical safety (non-negotiable)

- Exact address is never stored on a listing and never rendered. Store a lat/long **fuzzed by 500–1,500m** and display neighbourhood + city only.

- Safe Exchange Zones directory, suggested by default in the meetup proposal card.
 - Chat-embedded meetup card: proposed place, date, time, "share this meetup with a friend" link.
 - One-tap in-chat report and block, always visible, never buried in a menu.
 - Never expose phone numbers. If you later add calling, use number masking (Exotel/Knowlarity).
 - A published, honest policy: Craftgali does not guarantee any transaction. Say it plainly and repeatedly. Understating your limitations is what creates the lawsuit.
-

8. Listing & photo quality — automated aesthetics

The goal: make a Patna homemaker's phone photo look like a catalogue shot, with no human in the loop, and rank on quality rather than reject on it.

8.1 Pipeline

Runs async on upload; results stream back into the listing form.

Stage 0 – CLIENT (instant, free)

format, dimensions ≥ 1200 px shortest side, size ≤ 10 MB, EXIF orientation fix,
HEIC→WebP transcode, immediate feedback

Stage 1 – SAFETY (must pass; auto-reject)

NSFW / gore / weapons classifier (open NSFWJS or Sightengine)
→ any hit = hard block, no appeal for explicit content

Stage 2 – TECHNICAL QUALITY (cheap CV, ~50ms, OpenCV/Go bindings or a Python worker)

- Sharpness : variance of Laplacian; flag < threshold (blurry)
- Exposure : histogram clipping – >10% pure black or pure white pixels
- Contrast/dynamic range
- Colour cast : grey-world white-balance deviation
- Noise estimate : high-ISO grain
- Resolution & aspect ratio
- Duplicate : pHash vs corpus (Hamming distance ≤ 8)

Stage 3 – COMPOSITIONAL (segmentation, ~300ms)

- Subject isolation (BiRefNet / rembg / SAM)
- Subject-to-frame ratio → ideal 0.5–0.8; flag "too far away" / "cropped"
- Centering & rule-of-thirds offset
- Horizon/edge tilt (Hough transform) → the #1 fixable flaw in phone photos of framed art
- Background clutter: edge density + colour entropy outside the subject mask
- Occlusion: hand/foot/reflection detection

Stage 4 – SEMANTIC / AESTHETIC (VLM, ~₹0.20–0.50 per listing)

Send 1–3 images + the title to a small vision model (Claude Haiku, Gemini Flash, or GPT-4o-mini) with a strict rubric. Ask for JSON only:

```
{ aesthetic_score: 0-100, lighting: 0-10, background: 0-10, framing: 0-10,  
  colour_accuracy: 0-10, appears_handmade: bool, category_match: bool,  
  appears_ai_generated: bool, appears_stock_photo: bool, contains_text_overlay: bool,  
  contains_contact_info: bool, top_two_fixes: [string, string] }
```

Also validates that the photo matches the declared category and description –
catches "handmade ceramic vase" listings whose photo shows a mass-produced item.

Stage 5 – SCORING & ROUTING

$\text{composite} = 0.30 \cdot \text{technical} + 0.30 \cdot \text{compositional} + 0.40 \cdot \text{aesthetic}$

≥ 70 → PASS (Discover + featured eligible)

40–69 → SOFT PASS (live, but excluded from Discover; two named fixes shown)

<40 → HOLD with annotated feedback + one-tap "auto-fix and retry"

any hard flag → HUMAN QUEUE

At 5,000 listings/month, Stage 4 costs you roughly ₹1,000–2,500/month. That is one hour of a moderator's time. Run stages 0–3 on everything and stage 4 on everything at launch; sample it down later if volume grows.

8.2 Don't just judge — fix

Rejection creates support tickets. **Offer the fix inline**, one tap, always with a before/after and always reversible:

- **Auto-straighten** detected tilt
- **Background replacement**: segment the subject, composite onto a clean neutral wall / warm linen / studio gradient, with a generated soft contact shadow (the shadow is what stops it looking cut-out)
- **Auto white balance, exposure, and mild contrast** — not a filter, a correction
- **Smart crop** to 4:5 (feed) and 1:1 (grid) with subject-aware framing, so the seller uploads once and you generate every aspect ratio
- **Room-scale preview**: composite the artwork at true size onto a stock living-room wall. This is the single highest-converting feature for wall art — buyers cannot judge "60×90cm" from a number.
- **Auto-generated Instagram share card** (square, price, handle, subtle watermark)

Store the original untouched; enhancements are a derived rendition, never destructive.

8.3 Prevention beats correction — the guided camera

In the mobile web/app capture flow:

- On-screen frame overlay + level indicator; shutter disabled while tilt >3°
- Live blur warning
- Three-shot prompt: full piece → 45° angle/texture detail → scale reference (a hand or a common object)
- Contextual tips based on time of day ("Shoot near a window, avoid direct sun — indirect daylight is the single biggest improvement you can make")
- Optional printable neutral backdrop guide for small objects

8.4 Quality as a ranking signal, not a gate

Publish the rules and let self-interest do the work:

- Discover feed ranking includes the quality score directly
- Studio dashboard shows "Your photo quality: 62/100 — pieces above 75 get 3.2x more views" with the specific fixes listed
- Monthly "Best-shot pieces" editorial feature, chosen automatically from top scores
- A gentle nudge on old low-scoring listings that haven't sold: "Re-shoot this piece?"

8.5 Listing completeness score

Separate from photos, same philosophy. Weight: title quality, description length, story present, materials listed, hours invested filled, dimensions, ≥3 photos, price set. Show as a progress ring during creation ("78% — add materials to reach 90%"). Completeness feeds ranking. Sellers optimise what you show them.

9. Data model (core tables)

Postgres. Abbreviated to the fields that carry design decisions.

```

users(id, phone, phone_verified_at, email, email_verified_at, display_name,
      handle UNIQUE, avatar_url, city, geo POINT, radius_km, verification_level,
      trust_score, status, founding_seller_no, created_at, deleted_at)

seller_profiles(user_id PK, bio, creative_statement, cover_url, theme,
               response_time_median_s, completed_deals, joined_studio_at)

verifications(id, user_id, kind, status, provider, provider_ref,
              evidence_url, reviewed_by, reviewed_at)

listings(id, seller_id, slug, title, description, story, materials,
          hours_invested, stream, category, medium, price_paise, currency,
          dimensions_json, year_made, is_one_of_one, is_ai_assisted,
          handover_modes[], status, quality_score, completeness_score,
          published_at, expires_at, sold_at, geo_fuzzed POINT,
          search_tsv tsvector, embedding vector(768))

listing_media(id, listing_id, position, original_url, renditions_json,
              phash BIGINT, exif_json, is_primary)

media_quality(media_id PK, technical_json, compositional_json, vlm_json,
              composite_score, verdict, model_version, scored_at)

listing_slots(id, seller_id, source, slots, granted_at, expires_at, order_id)
-- ledger, never a counter column. Active slots = SUM(slots) WHERE expires_at > now()

plans(code, price_paise, slots, period_days, features_json, effective_from)
fee_bands(id, min_paise, max_paise, pct_bp, validity_days, cap_paise, effective_from)

orders(id, user_id, kind /*pack|pro|listing_fee|deposit*/, amount_paise, gst_paise,
        gateway, gateway_ref, status, invoice_no, created_at)

auctions(id, listing_id, start_paise, reserve_paise, min_increment_paise,
          starts_at, ends_at, extended_count, status, winner_bid_id, version)
bids(id, auction_id, bidder_id, amount_paise, idempotency_key UNIQUE,
      placed_at, status)
bid_deposits(id, auction_id, bidder_id, amount_paise, gateway_auth_ref, status)

conversations(id, listing_id, buyer_id, seller_id, last_message_at, status)
messages(id, conversation_id, sender_id, body, kind /*text|offer|meetup|system*/,
          payload_json, flags_json, created_at, read_at)

offers(id, listing_id, conversation_id, from_id, amount_paise, status, expires_at)

deals(id, listing_id, buyer_id, seller_id, agreed_paise, handover_mode,
       status, agreed_at, completed_at)

reviews(id, deal_id, author_id, subject_id, rating, body, published_at)

```

```
-- published_at NULL until both submit or 7-day window closes

reports(id, reporter_id, target_type, target_id, reason, detail,
        status, resolution, resolved_by, resolved_at)

trust_signals(id, user_id, signal, weight, detail_json, occurred_at)
-- append-only; trust_score is a materialised rollup

audit_log(id, actor_id, action, target_type, target_id, before_json,
          after_json, ip, at) -- append-only, no updates, no deletes
```

Notes:

- **All money in paise, as `BIGINT`** . Never floats.
 - `listing_slots` as a ledger, not a counter — you will need to explain to a seller exactly why they have 37 slots.
 - `embedding_vector(768)` with **pgvector** gives you visual "more like this," near-duplicate detection, and semantic search from one column.
 - `geo` with **PostGIS** for radius queries; store fuzzed coordinates separately from any precise ones and never join the precise one into a public API response.
-

10. Technical architecture

10.1 Recommended stack

Layer	Choice	Why this one
Backend	Go 1.23+ , modular monolith	Your call, and the right one. Single binary, trivial deploys, excellent concurrency for chat and auction close jobs, and cheap to run. Do not start with microservices.
HTTP router	chi + <code>net/http</code> stdlib	Minimal, idiomatic, no framework lock-in. (Echo or Fiber are fine; Fiber is not stdlib-compatible, which bites you later.)
API contract	Huma or oapi-codegen	Generates OpenAPI from Go, and TypeScript clients from OpenAPI. One source of truth for web + future mobile. This saves you weeks.
DB access	pgx + sqlc	Compile-time-checked SQL, no ORM magic, no N+1 surprises.
Primary DB	PostgreSQL 16 + PostGIS + pgvector + pg_trgm	One database does geo, vector similarity, fuzzy text, JSONB, and full-text search. Resist adding a second datastore until Postgres actually hurts.
Cache / rate limit / presence	Redis (Valkey)	Also backs OTP throttling and feed caching.
Background jobs	River (Postgres-backed)	Transactional job enqueue — you can publish a listing and enqueue its QC job in one transaction. Auction close, expiry sweeps, notification fanout, digest emails. Asynq (Redis) is the alternative if you prefer.
Object storage	Cloudflare R2	Zero egress fees. On an image-heavy product this is the difference between ₹8,000/month and ₹80,000/month vs S3.
Image serving	imgproxy behind Cloudflare CDN	On-the-fly resize/crop/WebP-AVIF, signed URLs, no rendition explosion in storage.
Realtime chat	Centrifugo (self-hosted, written in Go)	Battle-tested WebSocket server with presence, history, JWT auth, and channel permissions. Hand-rolling this costs 3 weeks and you will get reconnection wrong.
Search	Postgres FTS + pgvector at launch → Typesense past ~200k listings	Don't run Elasticsearch for 5,000 listings.
ML workers	Small Python service (FastAPI) for the CV/QC pipeline	OpenCV, rembg/BiRefNet, and detector models all live in Python. Go calls it over an internal queue. This is the one place a second language is worth it.
Payments	Razorpay (primary) or Cashfree	Fees, packs, subscriptions, and later deposit auth-and-capture. UPI-first, best India coverage, decent Go SDK.
SMS/OTP	MSG91 or Kaleyra	Get your DLT templates registered early — this takes 1–2 weeks and always surprises people.
Push	FCM (web + mobile)	
Email	Resend or Amazon SES	

Layer	Choice	Why this one
Auth	Phone OTP → JWT access (15 min) + refresh in httpOnly, SameSite=Lax cookie	Do not use localStorage for tokens.
Observability	OpenTelemetry → Grafana Cloud / Signoz; Sentry for errors	
Feature flags & config	Postgres-backed config table + admin UI	Prices, thresholds, and fraud rules must be changeable without a deploy.
Hosting	AWS ap-south-1 (Mumbai) or Hetzner + Cloudflare	Data residency and latency both point at Mumbai. Hetzner is ~5x cheaper if you're comfortable operating it.

10.2 Frontend

Next.js (App Router) is the right choice — keep it. The specific reasons for *this* product:

- Your artist portfolio pages (`/@handle`) and category pages (`/art/watercolour`) are your organic acquisition engine. They need server rendering, generated OG images (`next/og`), and **ISR** for cheap freshness. This is exactly what Next is best at.
- `next/image` + `imgproxy` gives you correct responsive images with almost no work — critical when images *are* the product.
- Largest React talent pool in India, by a wide margin. You will hire against this.

Alternatives, honestly assessed: **SvelteKit** produces a smaller, faster bundle and is genuinely nicer to write, but the hiring pool in India is thin. **Nuxt** is equivalent-but-Vue. **Remix/React Router 7** has better data-mutation ergonomics but weaker static/ISR story. None of these advantages outweighs Next's ecosystem fit here.

Supporting choices:

- **Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui** — but budget real design time. A marketplace for *art* that looks like every other shadcn dashboard will fail on vibes alone. Commit to a distinctive type pairing, a restrained palette that lets artwork carry the colour, and generous whitespace. The UI should recede.
- **TanStack Query** for server state, **Zustand** for the little client state you need. No Redux.
- **react-hook-form + Zod** for the listing form (it is long, multi-step, and must autosave).
- **Uppy** or direct-to-R2 presigned multipart upload with client-side compression before upload — do not proxy image bytes through your Go server.
- **Mobile:** ship an excellent mobile *web* experience first (your users are on mid-range Android with patchy 4G — budget hard for this: target <150KB JS on the listing page). Add **Expo/React Native** at v1.2, sharing the generated TS API client.

10.3 Things that will bite you specifically

- **Auction bid concurrency.** Never read-then-write. `SELECT ... FOR UPDATE` on the auction row inside a transaction, validate the increment, insert the bid, update `current_high`, commit. Client-supplied idempotency key with a unique constraint. Test with 200 concurrent bidders before launch.
- **Auction close must be exactly-once-effective.** A durable job with a state machine and a guard (`UPDATE auctions SET status='closing' WHERE id=$1 AND status='live'` — if zero rows, another worker has it).

- **Slot enforcement race.** Two tabs publishing simultaneously will both pass a naive slot check. Enforce with a transactional count against the ledger plus a partial unique index or an advisory lock per seller.
- **Fee band changes mid-draft.** Snapshot the band into the draft when the price is entered; honour it for 24 hours.
- **Chat is where your liability lives.** Retain messages, make them exportable for law enforcement requests, and run the safety classifier *before* delivery, not after.
- **Image upload on 4G.** Compress client-side to ~2MB before upload, resumable multipart, optimistic UI. A seller who loses eight photos to a dropped connection does not come back.
- **Handle squatting.** Reserve a blocklist (brand names, slurs, `admin`, `support`, all your route prefixes) before launch or you will be fighting `@craftgali-support` scammers in month two.

10.4 Suggested repo shape

```
/craftgali
  /cmd/api          - HTTP server
  /cmd/worker       - River job workers
  /cmd/migrate
  /internal
    /auth /user /seller /listing /media /search /discovery
    /chat /offer /deal /auction /review
    /billing /trust /moderation /notify /admin
    /platform       - db, cache, storage, queue, telemetry, config
  /db/migrations    - goose or dbmate
  /db/queries       - sqlc source
  /api/openapi.yaml - generated
/web               - Next.js
/ml               - Python FastAPI QC workers
```

Each `internal/*` package exposes a service interface and owns its tables. When one genuinely needs to be extracted into a service later, the seam is already there.

11. Success metrics

North star: *completed deals per active seller per month*. It is the only number that means the product worked for both sides.

Stage	Metric	Launch target
Acquisition	Seller signup → first published listing	>55%
	Time to first listing	<8 min median
Supply quality	Listings passing QC first time	>70%
	Median quality score	>65
Demand	Listing detail view → message initiated	>4%
	Search → listing click	>25%
Liquidity	Listings receiving ≥1 message in 14 days	>40%
	Listings marked sold within 60 days	>12%
Trust	Fraud reports per 1,000 listings	<3
	% of listings needing human review	<5%
	Median moderation resolution	<18h
Money	Free → paid seller conversion (90d)	>8%
	ARPU (paying sellers)	₹280/month
Retention	Sellers publishing again in month 2	>45%

Instrument from day one: every funnel step, every QC verdict with its score, every abandoned listing draft with the step it died on.

12. Risks and open questions

Highest risks, ranked

1. **Cold-start liquidity.** A marketplace with 500 sellers and no buyers is a portfolio hosting service. Go city-by-city (one city, one stream, 200 sellers) rather than nationwide-thin. Bihar/Patna is a defensible start precisely because nobody else is serving it, but Bengaluru or Pune have more buyer purchasing power for ₹10k+ work. Consider seeding demand with real-world events — a monthly Craftgali art market in one city creates the transactions that create the reviews that create the trust.
2. **Off-platform leakage.** Sellers who meet buyers once will do the next deal on WhatsApp. Since you monetise listings rather than transactions, this hurts you less than it hurts a commission marketplace — but it still kills your review corpus and your trust signal. Keep the reason to return on-platform: reputation, discovery, and the storefront.
3. **The first scam story.** One viral tweet about a Craftgali scam will cost you more than 10,000 signups gained. Over-invest in §7 before launch, not after.
4. **Paying before proving.** Asking ₹2,500 upfront from a seller who has never sold on your platform is a hard sell. Consider making the first high-value listing's fee waived or deferred.
5. **Quality drift.** As volume grows, the temptation to loosen QC to hit supply targets is enormous. Write the score thresholds into a config table with an approval requirement, and review the distribution weekly.

Open questions for you to decide

- Do you take a fee on auction *sales*, or only on listing? (Recommendation: listing only, consistent with the no-commission promise.)
- Do you allow made-to-order and commissions in v1, or only one-of-one existing pieces? (Commissions are the highest-value use case and the highest-dispute one.)
- Is the "handmade only" rule enforceable at your scale, and are you willing to ban resellers who bring volume? (Recommendation: yes, and say so loudly. It is the whole brand.)
- Which city do you launch in, and what is your plan for the first 200 sellers? This is a distribution question, not a product one, and it will determine the outcome more than anything in this document.
- Will you register as a private limited company before collecting fees? (You need this for a Razorpay merchant account and for GST on your service revenue.)

13. Build sequence (12-week MVP)

Weeks	Deliverable
1–2	Schema + migrations, auth (phone OTP), R2 upload pipeline, admin skeleton, CI/CD, staging
3–4	Listing CRUD, media renditions, seller onboarding, studio dashboard
5–6	QC pipeline (stages 0–3), Python worker, quality scoring, moderation queue
7	VLM stage 4, auto-fix (straighten, background, crop), guided camera
8	Discover feed, streams, search + filters, listing & storefront pages, SEO/OG
9	Chat (Centrifugo), offers, deals, mark-sold, reviews
10	Trust signals, trust score, new-seller cage, reports & enforcement
11	Billing: slots ledger, packs, Pro, high-value fee, invoices, GST
12	Founding-tier machinery, notifications, polish, load test, private beta with 50 hand-recruited artists

Recruit those 50 artists **in week 1**, not week 12. Build the product with them watching.